

Word family: **irritable / irritably / irritability / irritate / irritated / irritating / irritation**

Base word: irritable

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**

Related forms:

* **irritable** (adj.) — 易怒的；容易煩躁的；易受刺激的

* **irritably** (adv.) — 煩躁地；不耐煩地

* **irritability** (n.) — 易怒；煩躁；易受刺激性

* **irritate** (v.) — 使惱火；刺激

* **irritated** (adj.) — 惱火的；受刺激的

* **irritating** (adj.) — 惱人的；令人煩躁的

* **irritation** (n.) — 惱怒；刺激；發炎不適

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **feel irritable**

* **become irritable**

* **irritable mood**

* **irritable person**

* **irritable because of stress**

* **irritable skin**

* **irritable eyes**

* **irritate someone**

* **irritate the skin**

* **feel irritated**

* **an irritating noise**

* **skin irritation**

* **eye irritation**

* **irritability under stress**

Meaning in this passage

> The deadline was breathing down our necks, so everyone was tired, tense, and a little **irritable**.

Here, **irritable** means:

easily annoyed or made angry, especially because of stress or tiredness — 容易煩躁的；容易發脾氣的

The group was tired and under pressure, so everyone was more easily annoyed than usual.

****中文翻譯：****

截止日期已經逼在眼前，所以大家都很累、很緊張，也有點****容易煩躁 / 容易動氣****。

So here:

****irritable = 因疲勞、壓力或不舒服而變得很容易被小事惹怒****

1. ****irritable (容易煩躁的；易怒的) — 容易煩躁；容易發脾氣****

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Everyone was tired, tense, and a little ****irritable****.

大家都很累、很緊張，也有點****容易煩躁****。

Practice 2

> I get ****irritable**** when I haven't slept enough.

我睡眠不足時會變得很****容易煩躁****。

Practice 3

> He was unusually ****irritable**** that morning.

那天早上他異常地****容易發脾氣****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****irritable = 容易因小事感到煩躁、不耐煩或生氣的****

2. ****feel / become irritable — 感到 / 變得煩躁****

Practice 1

> She ****became irritable**** after working for ten hours.

工作十小時後，她變得很****煩躁****。

Practice 2

> I often **feel irritable** when I'm hungry.

我肚餓時經常會感到**煩躁**。

MCQ-ready definition:

feel/become irritable = 處於容易被惹怒或不耐煩的狀態

3. **irritable mood** — 煩躁情緒

Practice 1

> He was in an **irritable mood** all afternoon.

他整個下午都處於**煩躁情緒**中。

Practice 2

> Lack of sleep can put you in an **irritable mood**.

睡眠不足可以令人變得**容易煩躁**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritable mood = 一種容易不耐煩、惱火或發脾氣的情緒狀態

4. **irritable person** — 容易發脾氣的人

Practice 1

> He's not usually an **irritable person**.

他平時不是一個**容易發脾氣的人**。

Practice 2

> Stress can make even a calm person **irritable**.

壓力甚至可以令一個平靜的人變得**易怒**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritable person = 很容易因小事被惹怒或感到煩躁的人

5. **irritable because of stress / tiredness — 因壓力 / 疲勞而煩躁**

This is particularly relevant to your passage.

Practice 1

> Everyone was **irritable because of the deadline pressure**.

大家因為截止期限的壓力而變得**煩躁**。

Practice 2

> She becomes **irritable when tired**.

她累的時候會變得**容易發脾氣**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritable because of X = 因 X 所造成的壓力、疲勞或不適而變得容易惱火

6. **irritable (容易受刺激的) — 易受刺激的 ; 敏感的**

A major physical/medical sense.

Practice 1

> He has **irritable skin**.

他的皮膚很**容易受刺激**。

Practice 2

> Her eyes become **irritable** in dry air.

她的眼睛在乾燥空氣中很容易**受到刺激而不舒服**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritable = 身體部位容易因接觸、乾燥、化學物質等而產生不適或反應

7. **irritable skin — 易受刺激的皮膚**

Practice 1

> This cream is designed for **irritable skin**.

這款乳霜是為**易受刺激皮膚**而設。

Practice 2

> Strong perfume may affect **irritable skin**.

濃香水可能會刺激**敏感易受刺激的皮膚**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritable skin = 容易因產品、摩擦或環境因素而發紅、痕癢或不舒服的皮膚

8. **irritable eyes** — 易受刺激的眼睛

Practice 1

> Smoke can make **irritable eyes** worse.

煙霧可能令**容易受刺激的眼睛**情況更差。

Practice 2

> Dry air can cause **irritable eyes**.

乾燥空氣可能令眼睛**受刺激不適**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritable eyes = 容易因環境或其他刺激而感到乾澀、痕癢或不舒服的眼睛

9. **irritate someone** — 惹惱某人；令某人煩躁

Verb sense.

Practice 1

> His constant complaining **irritated me**.

他不停投訴，真的**惹惱了我**。

Practice 2

> The noise was starting to **irritate everyone**.

噪音開始**令大家很煩躁**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritate someone = 令某人感到煩躁、不耐煩或惱火

10. **irritate the skin / eyes — 刺激皮膚 / 眼睛**

A distinct physical sense.

Practice 1

> This soap may **irritate sensitive skin**.

這款肥皂可能會**刺激敏感皮膚**。

Practice 2

> The smoke **irritated my eyes**.

煙霧**刺激了我的眼睛**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritate a body part = 令身體部位產生不適、發紅、痕癢或炎症反應

11. **irritated (惱火的 ; 煩躁的) — 惱火的 ; 受不了的**

Practice 1

> She looked **irritated** by the delay.

她因延誤而顯得很**惱火**。

Practice 2

> I was **irritated** by his tone.

他的語氣令我很**不耐煩 / 惱火**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****irritated = 已經因某人或某事而感到煩躁或惱火****

12. ****irritated skin / eyes — 受刺激的皮膚 / 眼睛****

Practice 1

> The product caused ****irritated skin****.

這款產品令皮膚****受到刺激****。

Practice 2

> She rubbed her ****irritated eyes****.

她揉了揉****受刺激而不舒服的眼睛****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****irritated = 已經因某種刺激而發紅、痕癢或不舒服的****

13. ****irritating (令人煩躁的 ; 惱人的) — 惱人的 ; 令人煩躁的****

Practice 1

> That sound is incredibly ****irritating****.

那個聲音真的非常****惱人****。

Practice 2

> His habit of interrupting people is ****irritating****.

他經常打斷別人的習慣很****令人煩躁****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****irritating = 容易令人感到惱火、不耐煩或煩躁的****

14. ****irritating noise / habit / behaviour — 惱人的聲音 / 習慣 / 行為****

Practice 1

> The machine makes an **irritating noise**.

機器發出很**惱人的聲音**。

Practice 2

> That's one of his most **irritating habits**.

那是他其中一個最**令人受不了的習慣**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritating X = 會反覆或明顯令人感到煩躁的 X

15. **irritation (惱怒 ; 煩躁) — 煩躁 ; 惱怒**

Practice 1

> He sighed in **irritation**.

他**煩躁地**嘆了一口氣。

Practice 2

> I could hear the **irritation** in her voice.

我能從她的聲音中聽出**不耐煩 / 惱火**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritation = 因某事令人煩惱而產生的不耐煩或惱怒

16. **skin / eye irritation — 皮膚 / 眼睛刺激**

A major medical/physical noun use.

Practice 1

> Stop using the cream if it causes **skin irritation**.

如果乳霜引起**皮膚刺激**，就停止使用。

Practice 2

> Dust can cause **eye irritation**.

灰塵可能引起**眼睛刺激不適**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritation = 身體部位受到刺激後出現的發紅、痕癢、疼痛或其他不適

17. **irritability** (易怒 ; 煩躁) — 易怒 ; 容易煩躁

Practice 1

> Lack of sleep can increase **irritability**.

睡眠不足可以增加**煩躁和易怒程度**。

Practice 2

> Stress was affecting his mood and **irritability**.

壓力正在影響他的情緒和**易怒程度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

irritability = 容易變得煩躁、惱火或不耐煩的傾向

18. **irritability** (生理反應性) — 易受刺激性 ; 反應性

A more technical physical sense.

Practice 1

> Doctors monitored the tissue's **irritability**.

醫生監察該組織的**受刺激反應性**。

Practice 2

> Increased nerve **irritability** can cause discomfort.

神經**易受刺激性增加**可能引起不適。

MCQ-ready definition:

****irritability = technical: the tendency of tissue, nerves, or organs to respond readily to stimulation****

This is much less important for everyday learners than the emotional sense.

19. ****irritable bowel syndrome — 腸易激綜合症****

An established medical compound.

Practice 1

> ****Irritable bowel syndrome**** is commonly abbreviated as IBS.

****腸易激綜合症****通常簡稱 IBS。

Practice 2

> The phrase ****irritable bowel**** refers to a bowel that reacts abnormally or sensitively, not one that is “angry.”

****Irritable bowel**** 中的 ****irritable**** 指腸道容易產生反應或不適，不是「發脾氣」。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****irritable bowel syndrome = 一種涉及腹痛和排便習慣改變的腸道功能性疾病名稱****

Important distinction 1: ****irritable vs irritated****

This is the biggest learner distinction.

****irritable****

easily becomes annoyed.

> I'm irritable today.

我今天很容易煩躁。

****irritated****

already annoyed by something.

> I'm irritated by the noise.

噪音已經令我很惱火。

So:

irritable = disposition/state of being easy to annoy

irritated = actual result of irritation

Important distinction 2: **irritable vs irritating**

Classic **-ed / -ing** pattern.

irritable

easily annoyed.

irritating

causes annoyance.

> an irritable person

容易煩躁的人

> an irritating person

令人煩躁的人

Very different.

Important distinction 3: **irritated vs irritating**

irritated

person receiving annoyance.

irritating

thing/person causing annoyance.

> I am irritated.

我很惱火。

> The noise is irritating.

噪音很惱人。

Important distinction 4: **irritable** vs **angry**

irritable

easily annoyed, often by small things.

angry

actually experiencing stronger anger.

Someone can be irritable all day without becoming truly angry.

Important distinction 5: **irritable** vs **annoyed**

irritable

describes a tendency or general temporary state.

annoyed

describes a specific reaction.

> tired and irritable

累而容易煩躁

> annoyed by Kevin's comment

被 Kevin 的說話惹惱

Important distinction 6: **irritable** vs **impatient**

irritable

easily annoyed generally.

****impatient****

specifically unwilling to wait or tolerate delay.

> irritable because of stress

因壓力而煩躁

> impatient for the meeting to end

急着想會議結束

They often occur together but differ.

Important distinction 7: ****irritable vs tense****

Directly relevant to your passage.

****tense****

精神繃緊、無法放鬆

****irritable****

容易被小事情惹火

The sentence:

> tired, tense, and a little irritable

shows a natural chain:

****疲累 → 壓力繃緊 → 更容易煩躁****

Important distinction 8: ****irritable vs stressed****

****stressed****

feeling pressure.

irritable

one possible behavioral/emotional consequence of pressure.

Stress may make someone irritable, but the two are not synonyms.

Important distinction 9: **irritable person vs bad-tempered person**

irritable

easily annoyed, perhaps temporarily.

bad-tempered

more strongly suggests someone often has an unpleasant temper.

****Irritable**** is often milder and can clearly result from temporary causes like:

- * tiredness
- * illness
- * hunger
- * stress

Important distinction 10: **irritable physical sense vs sensitive**

irritable skin

easily becomes uncomfortable/inflamed.

sensitive skin

more common everyday wording for skin that reacts easily.

They overlap, but ****irritable**** can sound more medical or symptom-focused.

Important distinction 11: ****irritate = annoy vs irritate = physically stimulate****

Emotional

> His voice irritates me.

他的聲音令我煩躁。

Physical

> Soap irritates my skin.

肥皂刺激我的皮膚。

Same verb, genuinely different domains.

Important distinction 12: **irritation = emotion vs physical condition**

Emotional

> irritation in her voice

語氣中的不耐煩

Physical

> skin irritation

皮膚刺激

Context determines the branch.

Important distinction 13: **irritability vs irritation**

irritability

tendency to become irritated.

irritation

the actual annoyance or physical irritation.

> increased irritability

更容易煩躁

> irritation caused by noise

噪音引起的惱火

Important distinction 14: **irritable** does not necessarily mean **rude**

Someone can feel irritable but still control their behavior.

So:

> irritable = easily annoyed

does not automatically mean:

> rude / aggressive / mean

Family-extension note

Irritable has two major modern branches:

1. **emotional**

* irritable person

* irritable mood

* irritability

* irritated

* irritating

2. **physical sensitivity**

* irritable skin

* irritated eyes

* skin irritation

* irritate the skin

The verb **irritate** therefore splits neatly into:

3. **make someone annoyed**

* noise irritates me

4. **cause physical discomfort**

* smoke irritates the eyes

The underlying semantic thread is:

a stimulus causes an unpleasant reaction

That reaction can be:

* emotional → annoyance

* physical → redness, itching, discomfort

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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irritable	易怒的；容易煩躁的	easily annoyed	
feel irritable	感到煩躁	temporary state	
become irritable	變得煩躁	change of mood	
irritable mood	煩躁情緒	mood	
irritable person	易怒的人	tendency	
irritable skin	易受刺激的皮膚	physical sensitivity	
irritable eyes	易受刺激的眼睛	physical sensitivity	
irritate someone	惹惱某人	cause annoyance	
irritate skin/eyes	刺激皮膚 / 眼睛	physical discomfort	
irritated (emotion)	惱火的	already annoyed	
irritated skin	受刺激的皮膚	affected tissue	
irritating	惱人的	causes annoyance	
irritating noise	惱人的聲音	annoyance source	
irritation (emotion)	惱怒；不耐煩	emotional result	
skin irritation	皮膚刺激	physical result	
irritability	易怒；煩躁	tendency	
irritability (technical)	易受刺激性	physiological responsiveness	
irritable bowel syndrome	腸易激綜合症	medical term	

For your original sentence

> The deadline was breathing down our necks, so everyone was tired, tense, and a little **irritable**.

Here:

irritable = 因為疲累和截止日期壓力，而比平時更容易被小事惹得不耐煩或煩躁

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 截止日期已經逼在眼前，所以大家都很累、很緊張，也有點**容易煩躁**。

And the three adjectives are deliberately not redundant:

* **tired** → 累

* **tense** → 精神繃緊

* **irritable** → 容易被惹火 / 容易不耐煩

For this sentence, **「容易煩躁」** captures the nuance better than the stronger **「脾氣暴躁」** , because the passage describes a temporary stress reaction rather than Kevin's permanent personality.